The WaikouWander

2009 New Zealand Rogaining Championships 7th - 8th March
24hr and 8hr Rogaines

FINAL INSTRUCTIONS TO COMPETITORS.

Please ensure all your team members read this document. It contains important information.

Thank you for your entry in the WaikouWander. This information is sent to the team leader only so please copy it to all other members of your team. A copy is also available on the New Zealand Rogaine Association website, http://www.rogaine.org.nz . Attached is an Indemnity and Emergency contact form **to be completed by all members of your team** and to be handed in at registration.

See the NZRA website for a list of competitors, your team number (please remember it), and up-to-date information.

Organisers' Contact Details

The organisers may be contacted by telephone or email.

Peter Squires	Ph (03) 329 1714 Christchurch	Email: petersquires@ihug.co.nz
Bill Kennedy	Ph (03) 337 0364 Christchurch	Email: kennedyz@xtra.co.nz
Bob Cunninghame	Ph (03) 473 8330 Dunedin	Email: signalhill@xtra.co.nz
Entries:		
Emma de Lacey	Ph (03) 351 9743 Christchurch	Email: nzra.entries@gmail.co.nz
Buses:		
Dave Laurie	Ph (03) 332 4455 Christchurch	Email: lauriefam@xtra.co.nz

Contact telephone numbers for **emergency use** during the event are printed at the top of your map.

Directions to the Event Site

The event headquarters is at "The Hummock" woolshed about 30 km along Ramrock Rd. from Waikouaiti. The Hummock is distinctive in that the road passes through the middle of the farm buildings surrounded by very old and very large pine trees. Rogaine direction signs will be in place at critical intersections from midday Friday.

Waikouaiti is 40km north of Dunedin and 15km south of Palmerston on SH1. Ramrock Rd. heads inland from the southern boundary of Waikouaiti and is a metalled road. It is quite winding and narrow in places; take care. About 4 km from Waikouaiti, at the junction with Mount Watkin Rd, be sure to take the left turn along Ramrock Rd. Continue on Ramrock past Blucher Rd (another 6 km), Garden Bush Rd (another 8 km), Dempster Rd. (another 4 km) and Townsend Rd (a further 2 km). The Hummock woolshed is about 30km from Waikouaiti.

For an alternative route from the north, longer but less winding and offering less than 10km of metalled road, follow the Pig Route from Palmerston to just past Dunback; turn left on Macraes Rd through Macraes Flat. About 2.5 km past Macraes turn left onto Nenthorn Rd. About 8km along Nenthorn Rd turn left onto Ramrock Rd which is followed for 15km to The Hummock woolshed.

Camping at "The Hummock" Woolshed

There are adequate camping sites close to the start-finish area. They are available from Friday through Sunday nights. Please camp in the areas provided, which will be clearly signposted.

Water and toilets will be provided; otherwise you will need to be completely self-sufficient for camping except for the food supplied during the 24hr event. Please bring your own rubbish bags. Any cooking must be done with gas-fuelled stoves. Note that fires, smoking, dogs, and guns are not permitted anywhere at the Rogaine venue – campsite, administration area, and course.

Depending on the rainfall leading up to the event, water may be in short supply at the hashhouse. Please use it sparingly for drinking and cooking. It is not to be used for washing gear.

Important Note: If you are a competitor **and** the driver of a car please have sufficient sleep before heading home. The campsite is open all Sunday night for this purpose.

Event Timetable

Friday	4pm	Camping opens
	6pm – 9pm	Registration available
Saturday	7.30am	Registration opens
	9am	Maps distributed
	10.45am	Briefing for 8hr event
	11am	Start of 8hr event
	11.45am	Briefing for 24hr event
	12pm	Start of 24hr event
	6pm	Hash-house food begins
	7pm	8hr event finishes, meal available until 8pm. Note that teams finishing later than 7.30pm are disqualified.
	7.45pm	Results of 8hr event available
Sunday	8am	Hash-house food closes until 12.00pm
	12pm	24hr event finishes. Note that teams finishing later than 12.30pm are disqualified. Meal available from 12.00pm until 1.30pm
	1pm	Results and presentation
	1.30pm	Hash-house closes
	2pm	Buses depart for Christchurch and Dunedin
Monday	10am	Camping closes

Registration and Start Procedure

Between 6pm and 9pm Friday or after 7.30am on Saturday your team (one member is adequate) should present a completed Indemnity and Emergency Contact Form **(signed by each team member)** at the registration desk. Make sure you have entered your team number on the form. If no money is owing, the team will be issued with chits for maps, electronic wrist tags, and A3 waterproof Ziploc plastic bags for your maps. (Any money owing must be paid before map chits will be issued. Correct change would be appreciated). Any changes in team composition must be advised.

At 9am on Saturday, maps, checkpoint descriptions, A4 flight plan maps, and any last minute course notes will be handed out in return for the chits. Plan your route and mark it, including the direction of travel, on the flight plan. The event will not start until all flight plans have been lodged in the box provided at the administration desk. You may subsequently modify your route according to conditions as you progress, but the flight plan will give us some idea of where to start looking if you are in trouble. Don’t forget to put your team number on the flight plan.

All competitors must attend the compulsory briefing 15mins. prior to the start of their event; that is 10.45am for the 8hr event and 11.45am for the 24hr event. There will be electronic punches in the briefing area. MAKE SURE you initialise your wrist tag on one of these punches. Failure to do so will result in a reduced or cancelled score.

After the briefing your event will start at the appointed time.

If you have never been in a Rogaine before, novice instruction will be available at 9:30 am. Please ask.

Map and Course

The map is A3 in size, is pre-marked with the checkpoint positions, and has out-of-bounds areas overprinted. It is vertically oriented to magnetic north and the scale is 1:50,000 with 20m contours. The magnetic north lines are1 km apart. There will be one map per competitor. The map is not waterproof so bring contact covering or use the A3 plastic bag that will be provided.

The terrain is a mix of farmland and open tussock country with some areas of scrub and bush. The country ranges from gently rolling to steep. There are extensive rock outcrops in places and elsewhere there are scattered rock outcrops. Generally, movement is possible in all directions but there will be obvious routes following lines of ridges and streams. Altitude ranges from 200m to 700m over the course.

There are four water-drops on the course. These will be situated on the roads in the north and east of the course. In the south and west there is an abundance of good streams. The local farmers all say the water is safe to drink, but if in doubt, you may need to carry up to 4 litres of water, or chlorine tablets. Please use the water at water-drops for drinking only and do not waste it.

Remember that in Rogaining there is a distinction between “the” and “a”. For example, “The” watercourse means you can see it marked as a watercourse on the map, whereas “a” watercourse means that one exists, but it isn’t marked on the map.

Safety

All roads are open to the public and you must obey normal road rules and etiquette. In particular, Ramrock Road is a public road with traffic on it which won't know about the Rogaine. TAKE EXTREME CARE if you are travelling on Ramrock Road, and other roads for that matter.

Fences and tracks

As usual, tracks and fences exist which are not marked on the map, and others are marked that no longer exist. In many cases they serve as useful navigational aids, but you should not assume their accuracy without other supporting information such as contours.

There are a few electric fences which are easily crossed. Use your map (in its plastic bag) to hold the wires down while you cross them. Assume all electric fences are on. You are permitted to cross the few deer fences you may find, but avoid stock; particularly stags.

Weather and Equipment

This is an exposed area so be prepared for extremes of temperature and wind. Be prepared for temperatures of 35+ in the shade (and there is very little shade!), strong hot desiccating NW winds or cold SW winds with driving squalls of rain or hail. In settled conditions fog is not uncommon, while frost is another possibility. A weather forecast will be available at the registration area.

A suggested <u>minimum</u> equipment and clothing list is:

Polypropylene or woollen top and trousers. A warm hat and mitts.

A heavy waterproof parka.
Gaiters or leggings.
Food.
Water bottle (2 litres minimum).
A whistle each.
A basic first-aid kit for the team,
An extra jersey or fleece top.
Torches, and batteries for 12 hours.
A compass and pencil.
Suitable shoes or boots with a good grip.
A daypack

If you are in any doubt about the suitability of your equipment please ask an organiser.

You should expect to get wet feet, although you will be able to cover large distances without having to cross streams. There are many small watercourses hidden in the tussock, and there will almost certainly be heavy dew overnight.

Other Gear

You must bring a plate and cup, plus knife, fork, and spoon, for eating at the start-finish area. Bring toilet paper. There will be NO rubbish facilities so you must bring your own rubbish bag. A tent and sleeping bag are essential if you think you might stop overnight. Chairs and a table are also useful for planning your route. There will be a limited area available within covered sheep-yards and you can use your chairs and tables there if you are early enough; otherwise you should use your tent or car for planning.

Emergency

Blow your whistle (six blasts at one second intervals, repeated every few minutes) so that any other team in the vicinity can find you. If you have a cell phone call or text one of the phone numbers listed at the top of your map. Coverage is OK from ridgetops and high ground. Any team hearing the emergency call must respond and render assistance to the team that is in distress.

Scoring during the Event

There are 59 checkpoints, numbered between 20 and 92, with a total value of 3260 points. The checkpoint value is the "tens" value of its number, so for example 37 is worth 30 points, 53 is worth 50 points. Each checkpoint is marked on the map as a 7mm diameter circle, with the checkpoint number beside it.

All team members must visit each checkpoint you claim to within 5 metres of it. The checkpoints are marked with an orange/white flag tied to a bush, post, fibreglass pole or other object. They are not hidden and should be visible from at least 10 meters away, depending on your approach. As they have been placed in the field up to two weeks before the event we cannot be certain that all are still intact. If a checkpoint is missing, you must be able to describe its presumed original location to the score keepers to be credited with the points.

When you visit a checkpoint, each competitor with a wrist tag must place the punch in the tag until a red flashing light is seen. (Less than 3 seconds, and probably half a second.). If the punch doesn't flash, write down the 3-letter code visible inside it. All the wrist tags of a team's members must record a visit to a checkpoint to gain points for that checkpoint. (See the top of the homepage of the website www.rogaine.org.nz for further details on 'NAVLIGHT').

You must not stop at a checkpoint any longer than necessary to record your visit. If you want to stop for a rest or a discussion you must move at least 100 metres away from the checkpoint so as not to give its location away to another team (it spoils their fun).

There is a late penalty of 10 points per minute or part thereof after the finish time of your event, 7:00pm for 8hr competitors and 12:00 pm Sunday for the 24hr event. Disqualification (which means no score at all) will occur if you are more than 30mins late.

If you return to the headquarters during the event you should use a Finish Punch even if you intend to go out again. If you do subsequently go out for more checkpoints, use a "depart" punch at the administration desk and use a Finish Punch again when you return. The earlier finish time will be ignored.

Finish Procedure

At the finish, punch your electronic tag with a FINISH punch. The tag will then be cut from your wrist by one of the administration staff. Your entire team must finish together; the finish time will be that of the last team member to punch their tag. Remember, the penalty for finishing late is 10 points per minute.

Wait for your printout as your tag is read, and check your results. If there is anything you disagree with see the event organiser, NOT the person reading the tags. You will be asked to write down the problem in the log book provided. The organiser will decide on any adjustments, will write the request on your printout, and return it to the person doing the scoring.

Extremely Important: On no account are you to leave the event without handing in your tag. This is our check that you are off the course. If we don't have a tag a search for you will be mounted.

Protests

Reports of breaches of the rules, or protests against the event organisers, will be considered and determined by a three person jury. Such protests must be lodged in writing within 15 minutes of the end of the event. The jury panel for the Championships shall be selected from members of the NZRA committee and NZRA regional contacts, members of the NZOF Rogaining committee, and recognized rogainers. It will exclude the course planners and vetters, who may however be consulted by the jury. The fee for lodging a protest is $20 which will be refunded if judgement is in your favour.

Rules of Competition

The WaikouWander will be run under the standard competition rules which are available in full at http://www.rogaine.org.nz/main/CompetitionRules.htm . A copy of the rules will be available at the event center.

The following is an outline of some of the important rules:

- The only navigational aids that may be carried on the course are magnetic compasses, watches and copies of the competition map. The possession of other navigational aids, including pedometers, altimeters (including those within watches) and GPS receivers on the course is prohibited. The possession, at the event site, of maps that provide additional information not shown on the competition map is prohibited. The use of computers for course planning is not allowed.
- Members of a team shall remain within unaided verbal contact of one another at all times whilst on the course. A team shall demonstrate compliance with this requirement to any event official or other team on request.
- No food or equipment shall be left on the course before the event for a team's use, and no food or equipment shall be discarded on the course unless retrieved by the team during the event and brought by the team with them to the finish.
- All team members shall simultaneously approach to within 5 metres of each checkpoint for which points are claimed.
- No fires are to be lit anywhere on the course, this includes the camping area, and the administration area.
- Competitors shall not discard litter or smoke on the course.

All competitors must abide by the NZRA Code of Conduct which may be viewed at http://www.rogaine.org.nz/main/CodeofConduct.htm .

Acknowledgements

We are indebted to all the landowners who have so willingly allowed us to use their land. Without their cooperation we would not have an event.

The Hummock	Lindsay Dempster
Three O'Clock	John Grant
Lamb Hill Station	Chris Thompson
Summer Hills	John Scott
El Dorado	Murray Eason
4 Rivers	Mark Wear
Ben Doran	David Malloch

Douglas Dempster, Murray Dempster,
Brian Oldham, and Ian Ritchie,

and particularly Lindsay Dempster for the use of his woolshed and facilities.

We also greatly appreciate the assistance of the East Otago High School for their catering, and to the many others who have assisted us in so many ways.

Safety Sheet – The WaikouWander
24 and 8 hour Rogaines: 7th – 8th March 2009

Cancellation
This event will only be cancelled if conditions are extreme; to be notified at the start. The organisers reserve the right to shorten the event for safety or other reasons.

Your gear is your own responsibility. There will be no compulsory gear check but the organisers reserve the right to do checks on a random or selective basis. You must be suitably equipped to start.

We **strongly recommend** you carry:

a fully rainproof parka, second layer thermal top, long gaiters, showerproof over trousers, a high-visability reflective garment to warn traffic after dusk, a compass each, head torch, watch. You may wish to use walking poles.

Cell phone coverage is patchy to very good on high ground. During the event, the organisers can be reached on the cellphone numbers printed at the top of your map.

Safety is a top priority during this event. Organisers and participants (you) have responsibilities for safety. Your responsibilities include:

- being aware of and meeting all safety requirements specified by event organisers in writing, on the event web site, or verbal briefings,
- carrying all compulsory protective clothing and other safety equipment,
- advising your team member(s) of any medical conditions you have, your general level of fitness and other factors that may affect you adversely during the event,
- staying together as a team at all times, and providing mutual support, and helping any other team you find in difficulties,
- depositing a 'flight plan' map showing your intended course at registration before you start,
- recording each person's visit to a checkpoint with the electronic punch,
- advising organisers, and returning your tags, if you withdraw from the event or when you finish. This is our safety check that you are no longer on the course and **IS COMPULSORY,**
- being highly conscious of time and avoiding a late return – being late results in a hefty points penalty as well as raising safety concerns,
- being prepared to modify your plans to be more conservative if safety conditions dictate this,
- monitoring team and individual progress and fitness and modifying plans as required,
- looking out for hazards, such as:

1. **Hypothermia.** Wind, water and cold temperatures can lead to exposure or hypothermia. Early symptoms are subtle (clumsiness, lethargy, slurred speech). Be prepared to seek shelter or to call it a day if conditions are severe, or if any of your team is becoming exhausted. In severe weather keep off high exposed ridges.
2. **Dehydration.** Drink lots of water – we suggest you carry at least 2 litres per person. Water drops are marked on the map as "**W**".
3. **Streams**. Do not cross streams if they are heavily swollen.
4. **Cliffs, slippery rocks, loose rocks, incised creeks, gullies, slippery grass, hidden obstacles such as logs, loose fencing wire**, etc. may be present throughout the event area.
5. **Collapsed tunnels or 'under-runners',** especially on farm tracks
6. **Fog/low cloud**. If in fog, orientate the map and yourself with a compass. If in doubt, don't climb into cloud and descend out of it as soon as possible.
7. **Road Hazard:** There will be traffic on roads. No roads are closed during the event. The road code applies at all times; keep to the side of the road and be alert to traffic. We recommend you wear clothing with high visibility from dusk.

8. **Hunters**: We cannot guarantee that hunters will not be present in the area. We recommend teams carry a high-viz garment, and that you keep highly visible, and heard (shout and use your whistle) if you are concerned.
9. **Electric fences**. Usually the top wire, but sometimes a lower wire, may be hot (look for insulators on the post). Treat all as ON. Climb through lower wires, or use parka, pack or map for insulation.

In the event of serious injury or exhaustion, make the injured person warm and comfortable; arrange, if possible, to leave someone with the person; note your exact location on the map; seek help via the nearest road. Emergency signal – repeated (6 or more) short blasts on whistle at about 1 second intervals, repeated each 1 to 5 minutes. Repeat if you hear one long blast. We encourage you to carry a cell phone which may be useful in an emergency.

Environmental and farm care

Rogaining is an environmentally and socially friendly activity and we expect you to reinforce this ethic.

- Respect farm stock, fences and other facilities, and the right of landowners to operate their business, and lifestyle.
- **LEAVE GATES AS FOUND.** They will usually be shut. Shut them if you have any doubt.
- Cross fences at a strainer post, or climb through.
- Report any damage, or distress to stock, to the organisers
- Protect plants and animals
- Remove rubbish – more importantly, don't create it in the first place
- Bury toilet waste - better still, don't create it in the field - use the toilets provided at the START/FINISH where possible.
- Keep streams clean

This event is wholly on private land and we gratefully thank the farming families who have welcomed us for this event. Please ensure the trust they have placed in us is justified.

TEAM NUMBER: _____

The WaikouWander

7th and 8th March 2009

Indemnity and Emergency Contact

Teams will not be registered until the following form has been completed and presented at the administration desk.

Indemnity

We, the undersigned, hereby acknowledge that the New Zealand Rogaining Association, the Event Organisers, and the owners of the land used for this event, accept no liability for any loss, damage or injury to ourselves (including vehicles at the event venue) resulting from our participation in this event. We enter this event at our own risk and acknowledge that there may be risks associated with the sport of Rogaining. We understand the safety requirements set out by the organisers.

Name	Signature	Date	Date of birth

Emergency Contact

Your Name and Car Registration Number	Emergency Contact (not a competitor) Name, Address, Phone No.	Allergies or Medical Condition

NOTE:

1. A parent or guardian must sign the indemnity form on behalf of a competitor under the age of 18
2. Supply the name, address and telephone number of a person to contact in the event of an emergency. This person must not be a competitor in the event.
3. Supply details of any medical conditions or allergies that might be of assistance to First Aid staff in the event of an accident or emergency.